



PROBLEM

The current UDSM student ID-card collection process is manual. Students wait for cards to reach their colleges, then queue during office hours while staff search and sort large batches.

≈ 1 week before cards reach some colleges	Long queues after cards are released	Office hours limit student access
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OBJECTIVES

Main objective

Design and implement a secure self-service system that dispenses pre-printed student ID cards on demand and records every transaction.

- Detect each card and extract the registration number using OCR.
- Authenticate students using registration number, SMS OTP and PIN.
- Select the correct indexed slot and dispense only one card.
- Maintain audit logs and evaluate retrieval, authentication and error handling.

PROPOSED SOLUTION

A two-tier automated kiosk combines high-level computing with real-time mechanical control.

- Raspberry Pi 5: touchscreen interface, OCR, student verification, OTP/PIN authentication, database access and logging.
- Arduino Mega 2560: receives SPI commands and controls servo-driven card positioning and ejection.
- Indexed carousel storage links each verified student record to a physical card slot.

EXPECTED IMPACT

24/7 student access	Fewer queues	Lower staff workload	Audit-able transactions
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HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

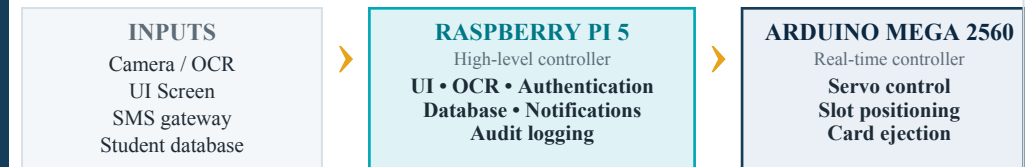
STAFF PRE-LOAD AND NOTIFICATION

1 Load cards Staff places pre-printed cards in the kiosk.	2 Capture + OCR Camera reads each registration number.	3 Validate + map Student record and storage slot are assigned.	4 Notify OTP and temporary PIN are sent by SMS.
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STUDENT RETRIEVAL

5 Identify Student enters registration number, OTP and PIN.	6 Authorize Credentials and card availability are verified.	7 Dispense SPI command activates the selected card slot.	8 Log Collection status and audit record are updated.
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SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE



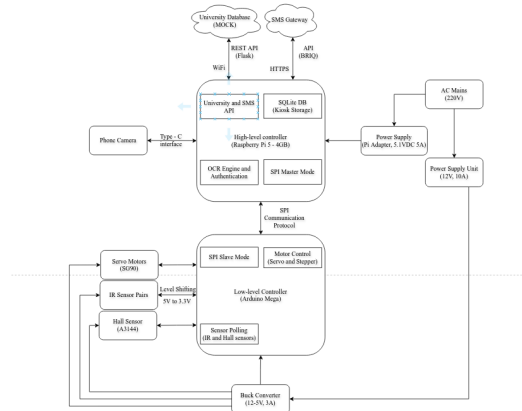
PROTOTYPE STATUS

- Functional OCR card detection and institutional registration-format validation were achieved together with audit logging of all activities in the system.
- SMS OTP, PIN verification, secure credential hashing and three-attempt lockout were implemented.
- SPI messaging and servo-control tests validated communication between the Raspberry Pi and Arduino Mega.

CONCLUSION

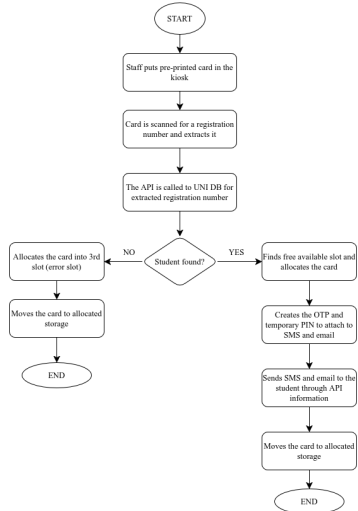
The prototype confirms that a secure, auditable and scalable self-service kiosk can automate the distribution of pre-printed student ID cards.

SYSTEM BLOCK DIAGRAM

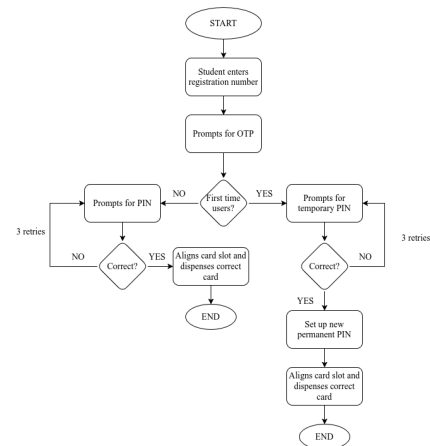


FUNCTIONAL FLOWCHARTS

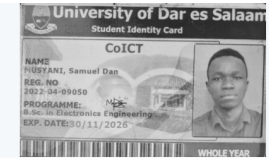
STAFF SIDE



STUDENT SIDE



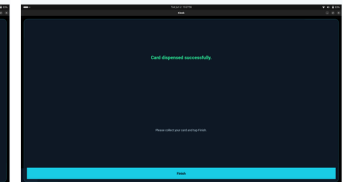
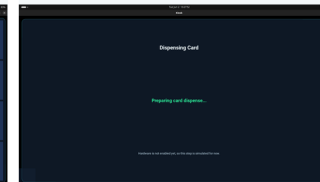
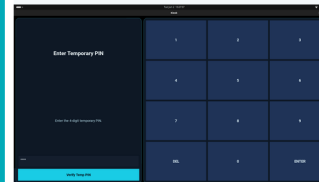
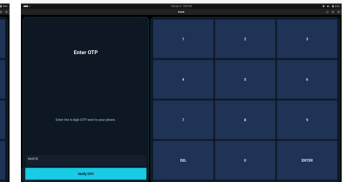
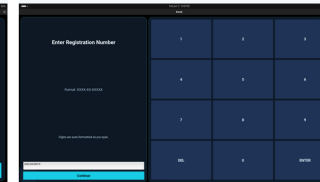
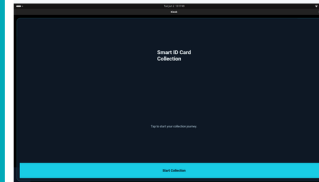
COMPUTER VISION RESULTS



2022-04-09050 2022-04-09050 2022-04-09050

```
{
  "confidence": 1.0,
  "error": None,
  "method": "ocr",
  "processing_time_ms": 788.887330001365,
  "student_id": "2022-04-09050",
  "success": True
}
```

CRUCIAL USER INTERFACE PAGES



FINAL PROTOTYPE RESULT

